

Business Travel Policy

VWGDS (Demo) — Enterprise Policy Pack

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Owner	Global Travel & Mobility Team	Effective Date	01-Apr-2026

This is a fictional demo document created for AI assistant / RAG training purposes. It does not represent an actual Volkswagen Group Digital Solutions policy.

1. Purpose

This policy establishes guidelines for all domestic and international business travel undertaken by employees of VWGDS (Demo), ensuring cost efficiency, employee safety, and compliance with statutory and tax requirements while enabling business objectives to be met effectively.

2. Scope

This policy applies to all full-time employees, management trainees, interns on active assignment, and contractors travelling on company-sponsored business purpose across India and international locations.

3. Definitions

Term	Definition
Domestic Travel	Any travel undertaken within India for official business purposes.
International Travel	Any travel undertaken outside India for official business purposes.
Travel Requisition (TR)	A formal request raised in the travel booking portal prior to any trip.
Per Diem	A fixed daily allowance provided to cover meals and incidental expenses while travelling.
Class of Travel	The eligible class of air/rail travel based on employee grade.

4. Policy

Booking Requirement

All travel must be booked exclusively through the approved corporate travel portal or designated travel desk. Employees are not permitted to book travel independently except in documented emergency situations, which must be regularized within 3 working days.

Advance Booking Window

Domestic travel must be booked at least 5 working days in advance; international travel must be booked at least 15 working days in advance, except for emergency business travel approved by the Reporting Manager.

Class of Travel Entitlement

Management Trainees and Executives are entitled to Economy class for domestic and international travel under 6 hours; Senior Management (Band D and above) are entitled to Premium Economy for international sectors exceeding 6 hours.

Ground Transportation

Airport transfers should use the empaneled cab vendor. Local conveyance during international travel should be limited to reasonable, receipted expenses.

Insurance

All international travel is automatically covered under the corporate group travel insurance policy; employees must carry a printed copy of the insurance certificate while travelling.

5. Approval Matrix

Scenario	Approval Required
Domestic travel (< Rs. 25,000)	Reporting Manager
Domestic travel (>= Rs. 25,000)	Reporting Manager + Department Head
International travel (any amount)	Department Head + HR Business Partner
Travel outside approved itinerary	Department Head

6. Workflow

Step 1. Employee raises a Travel Requisition (TR) in the travel portal with purpose, dates, and estimated cost.

Step 2. TR is routed automatically to the Reporting Manager for first-level approval.

Step 3. For international or high-value trips, TR is routed to the Department Head for second-level approval.

Step 4. On approval, the Travel Desk issues tickets and shares the itinerary within 24 hours.

Step 5. Post-travel, employee submits expense claims with original receipts within 7 working days of return.

7. Exceptions

- Client-mandated travel arrangements may override standard booking channels with prior written approval from the Department Head.
- Emergency medical or family situations during travel may be handled outside standard reimbursement timelines with HR approval.
- Travel to locations under a government-issued travel advisory requires additional sign-off from the Risk & Compliance team.

8. FAQs

Q: Can I book my own flights and claim reimbursement later?

A: No, except in a documented emergency. Self-booked travel without prior approval may not be reimbursed in full.

Q: What happens if my international trip approval is pending but the trip is urgent?

A: Raise the TR marked 'Urgent' — this triggers a 24-hour SLA for Department Head approval.

Q: Is per diem paid in addition to hotel and meal reimbursement?

A: Per diem is only applicable where meals are not otherwise provided or claimed separately; refer to the Forex & Expense Policy for detailed slabs.

Q: Can I extend a business trip for personal reasons?

A: Yes, with prior approval; the company will not bear additional travel costs arising from the personal extension.

9. Contacts

Contact Point	Details
Travel Desk	travel.desk@vwgds-demo.com
Global Mobility Team	mobility@vwgds-demo.com
Emergency Travel Assistance (24x7)	+91-1800-XXX-XXXX

10. Revision History

Version	Date	Change Description
1.0	01-Jan-2023	Initial release
2.0	15-Jun-2024	Added international insurance clause
3.0	01-Dec-2025	Revised approval matrix thresholds
3.2	01-Apr-2026	Updated advance booking windows